

CAREER PATHS

A formal degree is not always necessary to enter this career, but a vocational course or experience through volunteering will improve your job prospects. Career progression is usually achieved through specialization.

ASSISTANT If you have prior experience of working with animals, you can apply for work-based trainee jobs straight out of high school.



GRADUATE You will need an undergraduate degree in animal care management or animal sciences to enter this sector in a professional or managerial role.



ANIMAL CARE WORKER

Many animal care workers specialize in a particular type of care, such as rehabilitation through hydrotherapy—exercising animals in a pool of water—or massage. With experience and qualifications, you could move into training or managerial roles.



ANIMAL TRAINER Trains animals to respond to cues and commands. Trainers work with performing or working animals, such as guide dogs, or with rescue dogs and animals that have behavioral problems.

ANIMAL THERAPIST

Treats animals with joint or muscular problems by massaging muscles or flexing and stretching affected areas. Animal therapists need further qualifications for practicing.



STABLEHAND Provides daily care for horses at a yard or farm to ensure that they are healthy, happy, and in good condition. Duties include feeding, cleaning, and preparing horses for exercising and events.



PET GROOMER Keeps a pet's coat in good condition, advising owners on care of pet hair, grooming, and nutrition. Groomers can be employed by pet salons or may run their own business.



PET STORE MANAGER

Cares for animals, birds, and reptiles prior to their sale as pets, and provides advice to customers on the feeding, housing, exercising, and general welfare of their pets.

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent communication skills for interacting with colleagues, vets, customers, and visitors.



Good observation skills to monitor animals for different behavioral patterns and signs of any disease.



Physical resilience for working outdoors in all weathers and for lifting animals and bags of feed.



The ability to organize and prioritize routine tasks, and to manage time effectively.



Good computer skills for maintaining records and accessing the correct information for clients.